

support conversion of the HD video into an intermediate format for editing purposes.

The other drawback is that HD video uses the compressed MPEG 1 Layer 2 audio encoding at a bitrate of 384 Kbps. This is technically inferior to DV audio, which is encoded in uncompressed 16-Bit PCM at 1536 Kbps. However, MPEG 1 Layer 2 @ 384 Kbps is considered “perceptually lossless,” that is, the ear will be unable to detect the difference between the two audio encoding schemes.

2.3 Distribution Formats

Once you’ve shot your video, imported it into your PC and edited it, you are ready to distribute it. Deciding on which distribution format to choose will be dependant on the distribution media, the resolution quality, as well as the size of the resulting video file.

All video formats are encoded using a specific video codec. The video codec compresses the video (and audio) data to suit the requirements of the distribution media. Depending on the compression settings, this can result in a highly compressed video (smaller file size) with very low quality, or a large file size with good quality. There are also other technical considerations that may affect the quality of your output but those are beyond our scope here.

In general, the video editing software will provide you with options to convert into various popular file formats. The DV codec is not an easily distributable format, and you will need to choose in which format you want to encode your recording. MPEG-2, however, is a distribution-ready format, and if your camcorder is DVD- or hard disk-based and you do not plan to do any editing, you can set it to record at the optimum distribution quality. However, we do not recommend this. It is better to do your shoots at the best quality, transfer them to your video edit-